visits as an important part of my duties. There were two occasions when we flew to remote villages, Singha and Gelling, close to the border with China, where I inaugurated mini-hydel projects of 30–50 KW. The roads have not yet reached some of these areas. The generators were stripped into head loads and carried by porters to these remote destinations. There they were assembled and the projects completed. In many places I was told that the people were seeing a governor for the first time. All over Arunachal Pradesh there are 651 border villages covered through micro- and mini-hydel projects, and 523 villages have been provided with solar home lighting systems. These developments are part of the prime minister's package announced in 2008, and the remaining 1000-odd villages in the border belt would be provided electricity by the end of 2012.

We had been hearing of an important bridge over the Siang river being constructed by the Border Roads Organization in collaboration with Gammon India since the 1980s. This mighty river flows into India from Tibet, where it is called Tsang Po, and becomes the Brahmaputra as it joins the other major rivers like Lohit and Dibang.

It enters Arunachal Pradesh near Gelling village and flows into the Brahmaputra basin about 160 kilometres downstream. It is one of the most challenging rivers in the world for white-water rafting. The bridge over the Siang river (as it is called in Arunachal Pradesh) at Pasighat has great importance as it facilitates east to west movement in the foothills of Arunachal. This project had already taken more than two decades and was far from completion in February 2008 when I first toured the area. I flew over it a number of times and visited the site for a briefing. Considering the fact that it was a vital surface link and that none other than Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi had laid the foundation stone in the 1980s, the inordinate delay in its completion was incomprehensible. It was after three visits to the site and a warning that I would strongly recommend that some heads roll, that this languishing project was finally completed in August 2009 and opened to the public. Similarly, another significant road connecting the southern side of